



# MISSION ANALYSIS BRIEF

## CJEX 2026

DTG : 081015L MAY2026



# AIM OF THE BRIEFING



## **Request**

- Estimated additional force requirements

## **Approve**

- The operational framework
- Proposed C2 structure

## **Provide**

- Commander's Initial Intent
- Commander's D&G for COA development



# INTRODUCTION

## Outline

|    |                                   |
|----|-----------------------------------|
| 0  | Problem Statement                 |
| 1  | Review of the Situation           |
| 2  | Direction & Guidance              |
| 3  | Mission Analysis                  |
| 4  | Operational Framework             |
| 5  | Initial Force/Capability Estimate |
| 6  | Command and Control               |
| 7  | Operational Level CCIR            |
| 8  | Critical Operational Requirements |
| 9  | Critical Timings                  |
| 10 | Approvals & Guidance              |



# REVIEW OF STRATEGIC SITUATION (J2)



|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Political</b>      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Abidjan Peace Agreement's failure requires <b>robust operational posture</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Military</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>AFRC/RUF combat capability requires <b>persistent security and ISR presence</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Economic</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Rebel funding sustained by diamond mining, making <b>resource areas operationally decisive</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Social</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Civilian <b>protection</b> needed <b>on large-scale displacement areas</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Information</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Active <b>STRATCOM</b> is <b>vital</b> for information control <b>outside Freetown</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Infrastructure</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Protection and support required for <b>critical infrastructures</b> (APOD, SPOD, MSR's)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Physical</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>Rainy season</b> begins in May, limiting operations mobility, especially late month</li><li><b>Terrain and climate favour guerrilla forces</b> and constrain ground mobility</li><li><b>Threat dispersion</b> demands decentralised forces and multiple axes</li></ul> |
| <b>Time</b>           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><b>24-month mandate compresses timelines</b> for decisive effects</li><li><b>Delay benefits AFRC/RUF</b> and raises NATO strategic risk</li></ul>                                                                                                                         |



# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

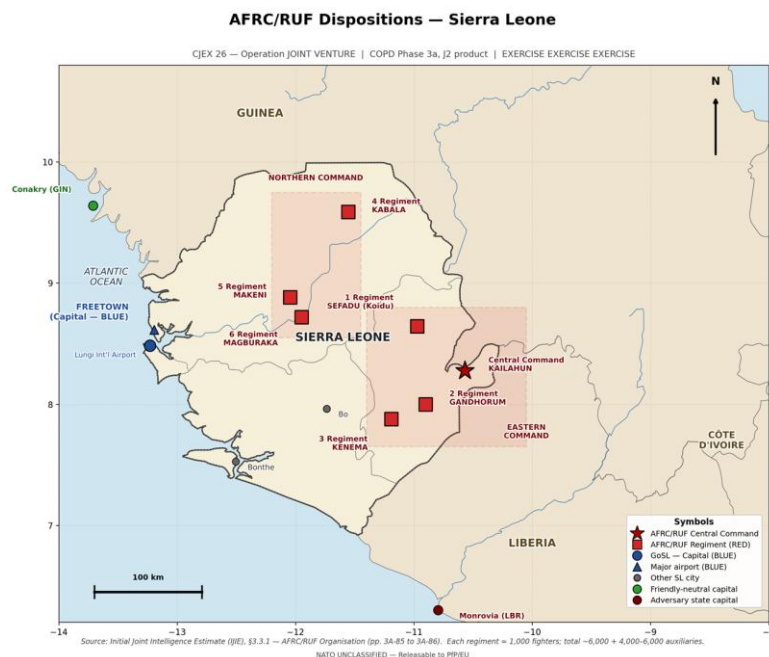
## Adversaries, Friends and Neutrals

### AFRC/RUF

#### Goals and Objectives

End state: take political control of SIERRA LEONE

#### Order of Battle and Current Disposition



#### Likely Intentions

- CONTROL diamond mine areas.
- CONTROL Liberian border area.
- CONTROL coast line between SULIMA and BONTHE.
- DISRUPT supplies from Freetown to government controlled areas.
- DISRUPT humanitarian assistance
- DISRUPT Foreign military assistance.
- EXPLOIT international diamond trade IOT fund own operations.

#### Conclusions

AFRC/RUF capable of dispersed insurgency operations throughout SL. Key terrain along land LOC will ensure control and FOM. Mining areas and LOC are essential and will be defended. CDF is the only opposing force for AFRC/RUF outside Freetown. AFRC/RUF will (covertly) disrupt APOD/SPOD IOT achieve their objectives. AFRC/RUF will exploit IDP situation



# OPERATIONAL DESIGN (J2)

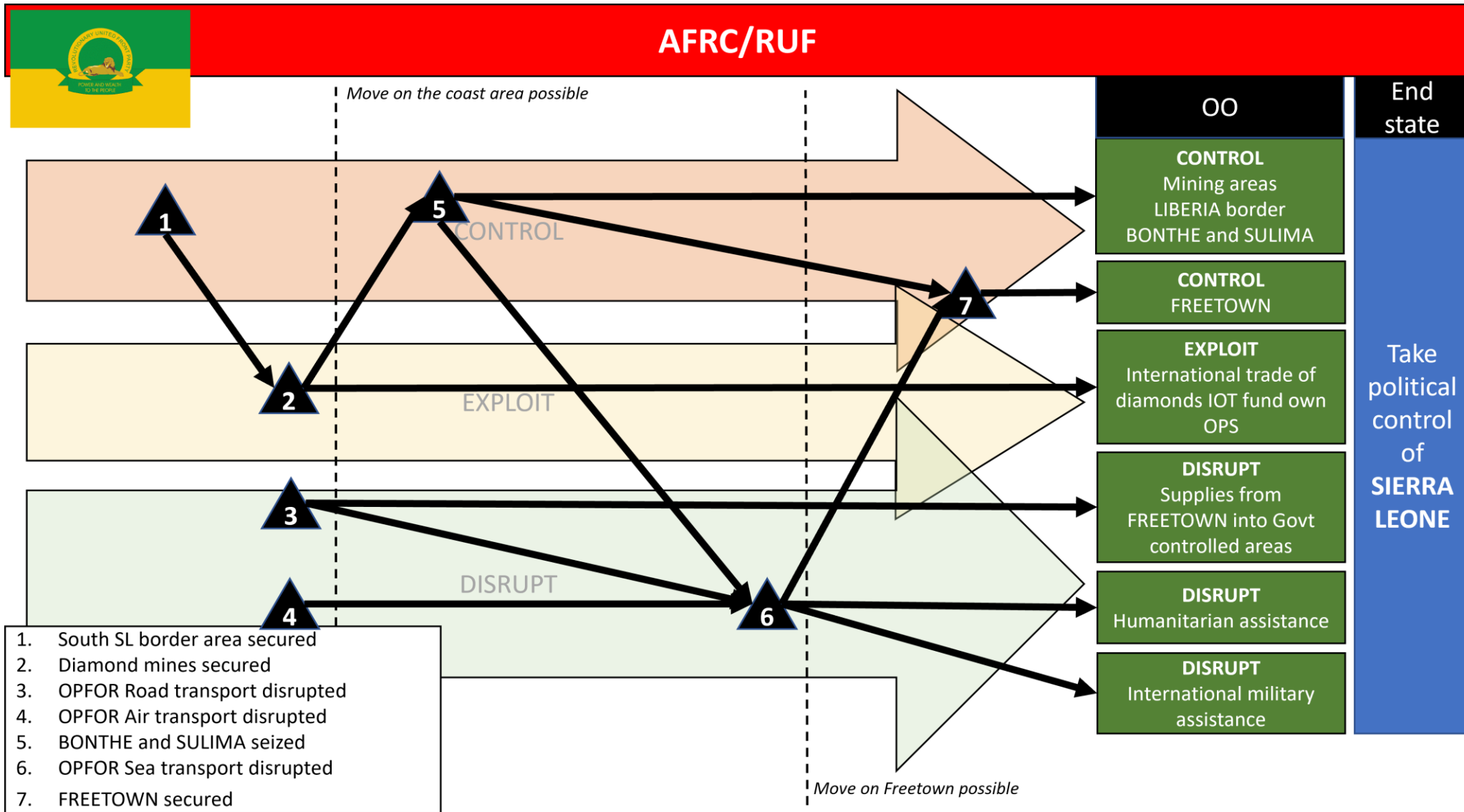
## Actor AFRC/RUF Operational Centre of Gravity

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Deduced Aim and Desired Outcome:</b> Sustain its power dominance – Remain dominant actor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Centre of Gravity</b><br><i>AFRC / RUF combat Forces</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>Critical Capabilities :</b> Ability to <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1. Control terrain in Eastern / Northern SL</li><li>2. Monetise diamonds to fund arms via Liberia</li><li>3. Coerce civilians for recruitment and intelligence support</li><li>4. Conduct guerrilla operations</li><li>5. Sustain itself logistically with minimal footprint</li><li>6. Maintain external support from LBR</li></ol>                            |
| <b>Critical Vulnerabilities</b> <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1.1.1 Cohesion depends on F. SANKOH</li><li>2.1.1 Diamond fields exposed to ISR</li><li>3.1.1 Small number of LBR-SL diamonds crossings points</li><li>4.1.1 Coercive legitimacy is weak</li><li>5.1.1 Conditional Liberian support directly affects RUF resupply</li><li>5.2.1 No air or armour means; air defence limits but does not deny NATO air capacity</li><li>6.1.1 Exploitable Comms</li><li>6.2.1 Internal friction (AFRC vs RUF)</li></ol> | <b>Critical Requirements</b> <ol style="list-style-type: none"><li>1.1 Inter-factional cohesion (F. SANKOH)</li><li>2.1 Diamond economy</li><li>3.1 Functional C2 (mobile phones, VHF, and runner-couriers)</li><li>4.1 Cross-border diamond smuggling corridors</li><li>5.1 Compliant/fearful population</li><li>5.2 External sponsorship (LBR)</li><li>6.1 Loyal-citizen network in GovSL-held areas</li><li>6.2 Favourable terrain</li></ol> |
| <b>Conclusion:</b> <i>AFRC/RUF's center of gravity rests on the interconnected leadership–economy–sponsor triangle; disrupting these links isolates the force, degrades leadership, and collapses its fighting effectiveness while enabling a credible alternative security provider for the population.</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |



# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

## AFRC/RUF – Operational Framework







# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

## AFRC/RUF – Most Likely COA



### MOST LIKELY COA



### Purpose and Objectives

Take political control of SIERRA LEONE through a slow-tempo, dry-season attack that protects the AFRC/RUF strategic CoG (diamond-funded armed wing under Sankoh) and denies GoSL the capacity to project force outside FREETOWN.

### Actions (Time, Space, Forces)

TIME: 3-stage dry-season campaign (Nov 26–Apr 27).

Phase 1 Posture (D-7→D+0) — concentrate forces

Phase 2 Engage (D+0→D+30) — defend DCs, expand disruption, encroach BONTHE/SULIMA.

Phase 3 Decide (D+30→D+60) — sustain interdiction, control coast, political pressure on FT.

SPACE: Centre-of-mass = Eastern diamond belt (KAILAHUN/KENEMA/PUJEHUN). LBR border salient = sustainment bridge. KENEMA-BO-FREETOWN axis = disruption corridor. Southern coast (BONTHE-SULIMA) = lateral effort.

FORCES: ~4–6,000 RUF/AFRC fighters across Eastern, Central, Southern, Western brigades; LBR sponsor enablers (logistics, SF advisors); AFRC sleeper networks inside FREETOWN.

### Conclusions

- ML CoA : dry-season slow tempo, low-signature attacks, mines defended at all costs.
- Single most important DC = DC-2 (diamond mines).
- ML is recoverable for Blue: chronic pattern leaves time for WAFOR build-up and ECOMOG reinforcement.





## AFRC/RUF – Most Dangerous COA

## Purpose and Objectives

Take political control of SIERRA LEONE rapidly, before WAFOR establishes credible joint posture. Synchronised pre-emptive strike combining LBR FOXTROT/MIG-23/SF with RUF urban infiltration.

## Actions (Time, Space, Forces)

TIME: ~45-day compressed campaign.

Phase 1 Posture (D-21→D-1) — FOXTROT/OSA/MIG-23 prep, MANPADS, mortar, SF inside SL.

Phase 2 Engage (D+0→D+14) — synchronised attack: FOXTROT sortie + OSA attack SPOD; H-hour Lungi mortar bombardment; cratering KENEMA-BO-FT axis; attack BONTHE/SULIMA.

Phase 3 Decide (D+14→D+45) — deliberate FREETOWN assault.

SPACE: Maritime SPOD approach (Sherbro Strait, FT approaches) + Lungi APOD + BONTHE/SULIMA littoral + KENEMA-BO-FT axis + FREETOWN urban districts

FORCES: Same RUF/AFRC ground brigades as ML PLUS the LBR capability committed: 2 x FOXTROT submarines, OSA-class FAC, MIG-23 , Recon/SF cells. sleeper AFRC networks in FREETOWN activated as a single attack

## Conclusions

- Probability low, consequence catastrophic — particularly D-21→D+14
- Most decisive = DC-6 (sea tpt disrupted) executed by FOXTROT in initial phase.
- it is assessed that MD is NOT recoverable for Blue if FOXTROT sortie + APOD bombardment + attack on BONTHE/SULIMA all succeed within 14 days.





# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

## Adversaries, Friends and Neutrals

# LIBERIA

### Goals and Objectives

End state: achieve regional hegemony and counter growing Western influence in the region.

### Likely Intentions

- SEIZE/INTERDICT diamond mining areas IOT stabilise delivery to LB.
- SUPPORT AFRC/RUF IOT have them gain control in SL.
- CONTROL anti-Liberian rebels (LURD) nationally.
- THREATEN regional security IOT counter international capitalism.

### Order of Battle and Current Disposition

AFRC/RUF and AFL Dispositions — Sierra Leone



Sources: [IE Serial 3A — §3.3.1 AFRC/RUF Organisation (pp. 3A-85/86); §3.3.2 LIBERIA, Table 22 AFJArmy (pp. 3A-89/91).  
AFRC/RUF: ~6,000 fighters + 4,000-6,000 aux. AFL inside SL: 1 Inf Bn (21mm-Kalashnikov); 4 Inf Bn det. (vic. Koinema). AFL Navy PCFG No 203 at sea outside SL.  
NATO UNCLASSIFIED — Releaseable to PPPLV. | EXERCISE EXERCISE EXERCISE

### Conclusions

Securing diamond revenue is essential for LB.

LB is willing and able to deploy troops across the border.

AFRC/RUF is a means to and end for LB. Level and nature of support may vary.

Local Sea Denial by submarines can pose a serious threat to SPOD.

LB will exploit IDP situation.



# OPERATIONAL DESIGN (J2)

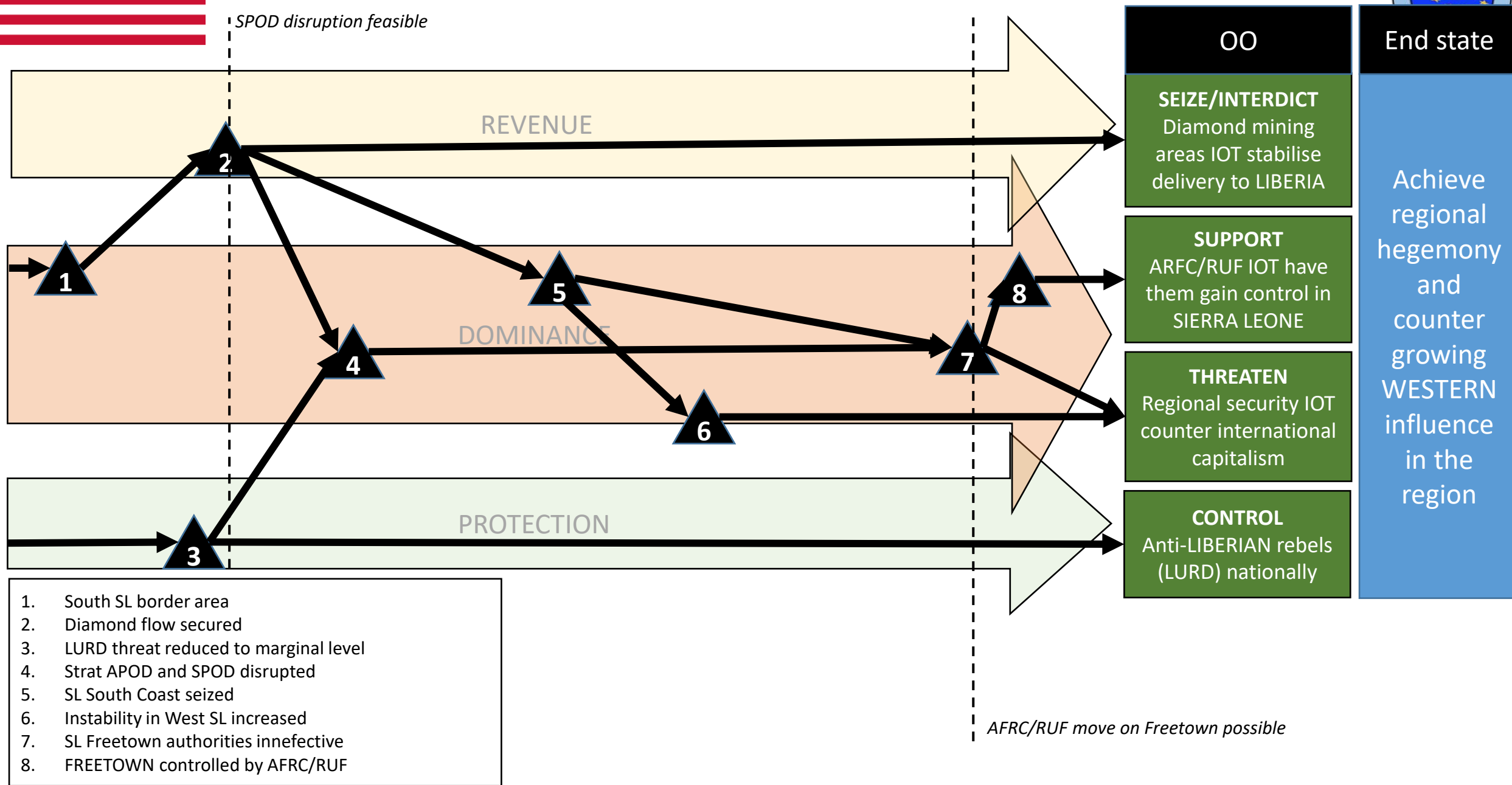
## Actor **LIBERIA** Operational Centre of Gravity

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| <b>Deduced Aim and Desired Outcome:</b> Regional dominance – Counter Western influence – Protect Sherbro and Mende                                                                                                                  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
| <b>Centre of Gravity</b><br><b>LAND FORCES</b>                                                                                                                                                                                      |  | <b>Critical Capabilities :</b> Ability to<br>1. Control LOC between mines and LB<br>2. Protect and control the borders with SL and GU<br>3. Deny western military intervention<br>4. Support (Train-Equip-Sustain) RUF/AFRC<br>5. Disrupt SSR/DDR process<br>6. Influence SL and LB population<br>7. Conduct COIN Ops<br>8. Conduct Off Ops |  |
| <b>Critical Vulnerabilities</b><br>1.2.1 ISR depend on Russia<br>3.2.1 Two Submarines<br>3.3.1 Limited Air means<br>3.4.1 Limited EW<br>6.1.1 Limited EW<br>8.1.1 Sustainment (Off)                                                 |  | <b>Critical Requirements</b><br>1.1 Land Forces in SL<br>1.2 ISR<br>2.1 Land Forces at borders<br>2.2 ISR<br>3.1 SF<br>3.2 Submarines<br>3.3 Air Defense Systems<br>3.4 Cyber/EW<br>4.1 SF<br>5.1 SF<br>6.1 EW/Cyber/Info Ops Cap/Psy Ops Cap<br>7.1 Internal Security Forces<br>8.1 Land Forces – Min Bde                                  |  |
| <b>Conclusion:</b> <i>LB Land Forces in Sierra Leone ensure the diamond resources importation which support the LB economy. Furthermore, Land Forces guarantee exportation of weapons and effective ground support to RUF/AFRC.</i> |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |



# LIBERIA

*SPOD disruption feasible*







# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

## LIBERIA – Most Likely COA

### MOST LIKELY COA



### Purpose and Objectives

Support RUF/AFRC to instaurate Liberian influence on SL in order to achieve regional dominance

### Actions (Time, Space, Forces)

Forces: Liberia will mainly support the RUF/AFRC to reach its objectives. The use of forces will be mainly covert and minimum.

Time: the scenario is a long-term approach which can be measured in years

Phase 1 : CONSOLIDATE

Phase 2 : ISOLATE

Phase 3 : TAKE CONTROL

Space: The influence on the east part of SL (diamond mines) is paramount

### Conclusions:

The RUF/AFRC is the main opponent for WAFOR. LIBERIA conduct an indirect approach



# REVIEW OF SITUATION (J2)

## LIBERIA - Most Dangerous COA

### **MOST DANGEROUS COA**



### **Purpose and Objectives**

OCCUPY Eastern SL and actively support RUF/AFRC to instaure Liberian influence on SL in order to achieve regional dominance,

### **Actions (Time, Space, Forces)**

Forces: Liberia will deploy military forces in SL in direct support of RUF/AFRC.

Time: This scenario is a short-term approach reaching to ASAP overturn the SL control in to rebels hands.

Phase 1 : CONSOLIDATE

Phase 2 : OFFENSIVE

Phase 3 : TAKE CONTROL

Space: the East part still paramount for diamond control but the main accesses from east to Freetown will be targeted

### **Conclusions**

**The LIBERIA became the main threat to security using a direct approach justified by the protection of SHERBRO and MENDE**





# REVIEW OF SITUATION (XO)

## D&G for Mission Analysis



**Political and SACEUR Direction and Guidance **UNCHANGED****

### **Your guidance**

Key issues and areas of specific attention are considered, and coordination and liaison requirements are taken into account.

### **Conclusions**

Non-aggressive posture vs. robust force needs to be in balance.  
The mission needs a comprehensive approach in which IO are key.  
End state needs to be achieved within 24 months.  
Because of the infrastructure and climate, logistics play a vital role.



From a sustainment perspective, WAFOR operations are feasible provided that the initial force build up is through GUINEA

During the rainy season — which has just started — WAFOR must rely on limited paved MSRs, establish convoy support centres every 100km, prioritise fuel distribution and maintain the GUINEA technical agreement — which is assessed precondition for success WAFOR cannot initially rely on SIERRA LEONE as the main logistics base, due to constrained XPODs and unreliable host nation support

WAFOR should use CONAKRY as the strategic coupling bridge, primary SPOD, JLSG location and purple gate for NSEs

WAFOR can use FREETOWN as a limited initial coupling bridge

WAFOR's medical support is feasible and assessed as self sufficient

WAFOR should deploy a Role 3 hospital to CONAKRY & FREETOWN and consider aviation for CASEVAC.

Reception staging onward movement & integration should occur through GUINEA initially. This permits combat-ready forces to transit GUINEAN territory provided that they do not conduct combat operations there. WAFOR's conduct in GUINEA must be carefully managed

It shall take a minimum of 20 days from activation for Tier 1 forces to be received and staged. This includes NTM and transit by sea.

Joint Logistics Enablers, as APOD & SPOD handling units, must be in theatre 7 days before the arrival of the first combat units. Organic APOD & SPOD

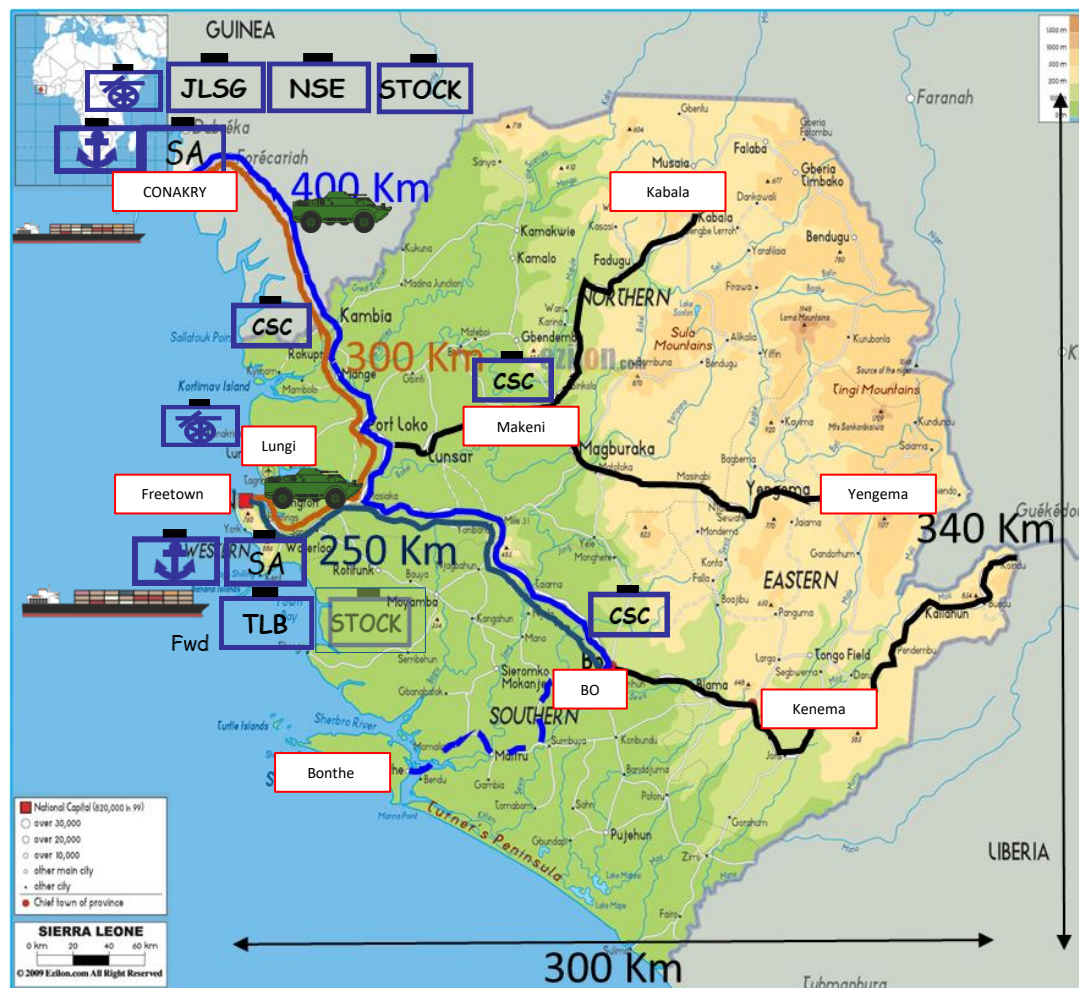
FREETOWN SPOD and LUNGI APOD should only support an initial entry force to SIERRA LEONE, should that be necessary — until infrastructure is improved.

WAFOR should not consider BONTHE as an initial entry or sustainment node. MSR & APOD construction works... All MSRs should be considered contested.



# MISSION ANALYSIS (J4)

## Log Deploy Concept (Infra)



- 2 SPOD/ 1 APOD
  - CONAKRY port (1st phase) (2 Berth)
  - FREETOWN port (2nd phase) (1 Berth)
  - LUNGI Airport (1st phase)
- Initial build up = CONAKRY
  - JSLG + NSE+ Stock
  - Create a more robust HNS in Guinea
    - BUT purification of H2O still needed
  - Initial stock buildup of 10 DOS in CONAKRY + 7CDOS + 13 DOS FOS
- CSC = every 100 Km (CSC at the border is fixed- other CSC COA related)
- No road between BONTHE and BO => under construction but this combined with security situation makes SPOD BONTHE not an option in this phase

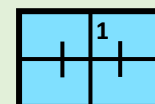
### Conclusion

Rainy season (May-Nov): only paved MSRs passable  
Initial Log buildup = CONAKRY

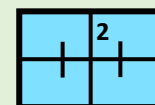


# MISSION ANALYSIS (J4)

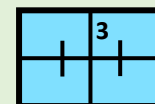
## Medical deploy & support Concept



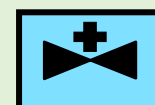
Tactical units – **National responsibility**



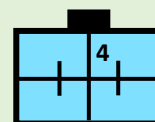
Tactical units – **National responsibility**



LCC HQ (Sierra Leone) – **Lead Nation**  
Theater Logistical Base (Guinea) – **Multinational**



**Intratheatre evacuation**  
HH-60: 250 - 275 km (1h)  
HH-60 (ESSS): 400 - 440 km (2h)



Inter-theatre evacuation – **National responsibility**  
National-based hospitals

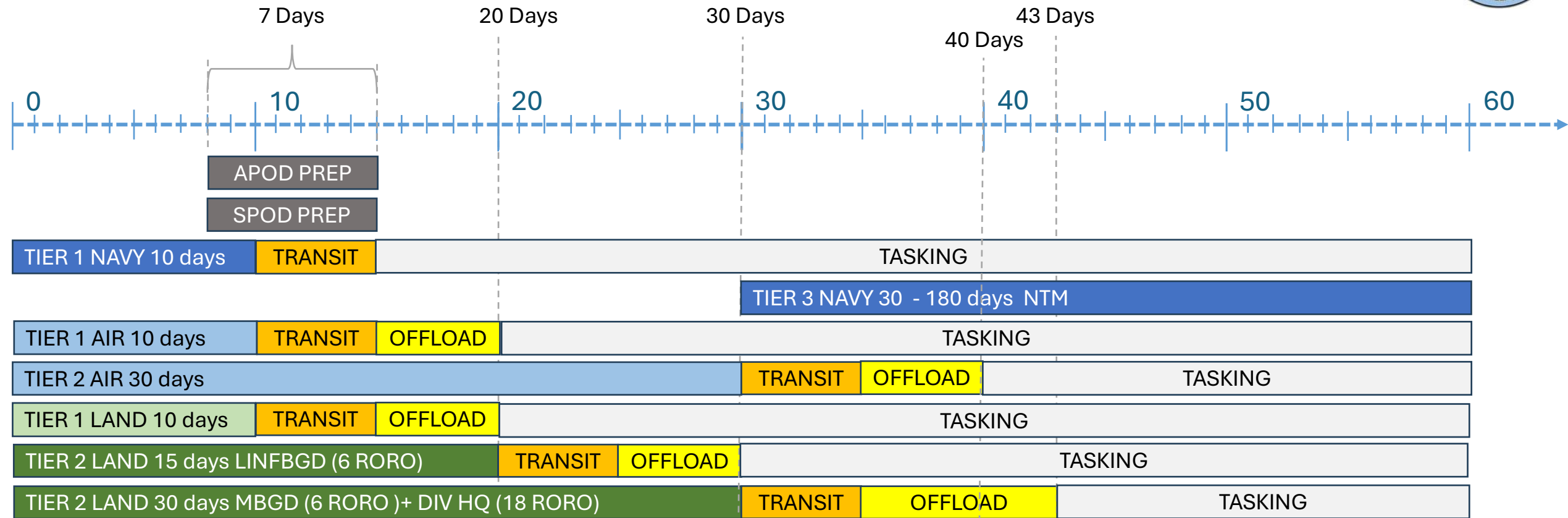
### Conclusion

No significant constraints to medical support are anticipated.



# Deployment Timeline TIER 1 – TIER 2

## SPOD CONAKRY (GUINEA)



### Consume rate / Day (LAND & AIR):

| <u>DAY:</u> | <u>DAY 20</u>             | <u>DAY 30</u>             | <u>DAY 40</u>             | <u>DAY 43</u>             |
|-------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| CLASS I     | 28 TEU                    | 43 TEU                    | 49 TEU                    | 80 TEU                    |
| CLASS II    | 6 TEU                     | 6 TEU                     | 7 TEU                     | 8 TEU                     |
| CLASS III   | 2 302 M <sup>3</sup> Fuel | 2 444 M <sup>3</sup> Fuel | 3 404 M <sup>3</sup> Fuel | 3 687 M <sup>3</sup> Fuel |
| CLASS V     | 575 TEU                   | 585 TEU                   | 836 TEU                   | 857 TEU                   |

### CAPACITY

SPOD CONAKRY  
2 RORO / 6 HRS

SPOD FREETOWN  
1 RORO / 6 HRS





# MISSION ANALYSIS (J5)



# **Mission Analysis Brief – J5**

**CJEX 2026 – DTG : 08 0930 A MAY 26**

**Prepared by: J5 Strategic Plans**

**Audience: Gen M Beary – JFC SACEUR**



# Mission Analysis Brief – J5

CJEX 2026 – DTG : 08 0930 A MAY 26

Prepared by: J5 Strategic Plans

Audience: Gen M Beary – JFC SACEUR

## J5 MAP Brief Contribution (20min best ,30max)

- *Key Factors & Conclusions*
- *Operational Limitations & Assumptions*
- *Operational Risks & Opportunities*
- *DRAFT Mission Statement*
- *Operational Objectives & COG Analysis*
- *Initial Commander's Intent*
- *DRAFT Operational Framework*
- *Complementary Non-Mil Actions*
- *Initial Force Estimate*
- *Command & Control*
- *Critical Operational Requirements*

Q&A





# J5 Plan 30 Second Strategic Overview

## AFRC/RUF Insurgency

*Armed Factions have seized control of key Provinces*

*Systematic violence, atrocities against civilians, collapse of state security structures*

## Diamond-Funded Conflict Economy

*Eastern Diamond fields controlled by insurgent groups – funds procurement*

*Revenue is flowing to and from Liberia, sustaining the insurgency cycle*

## Liberian External Support & Interference

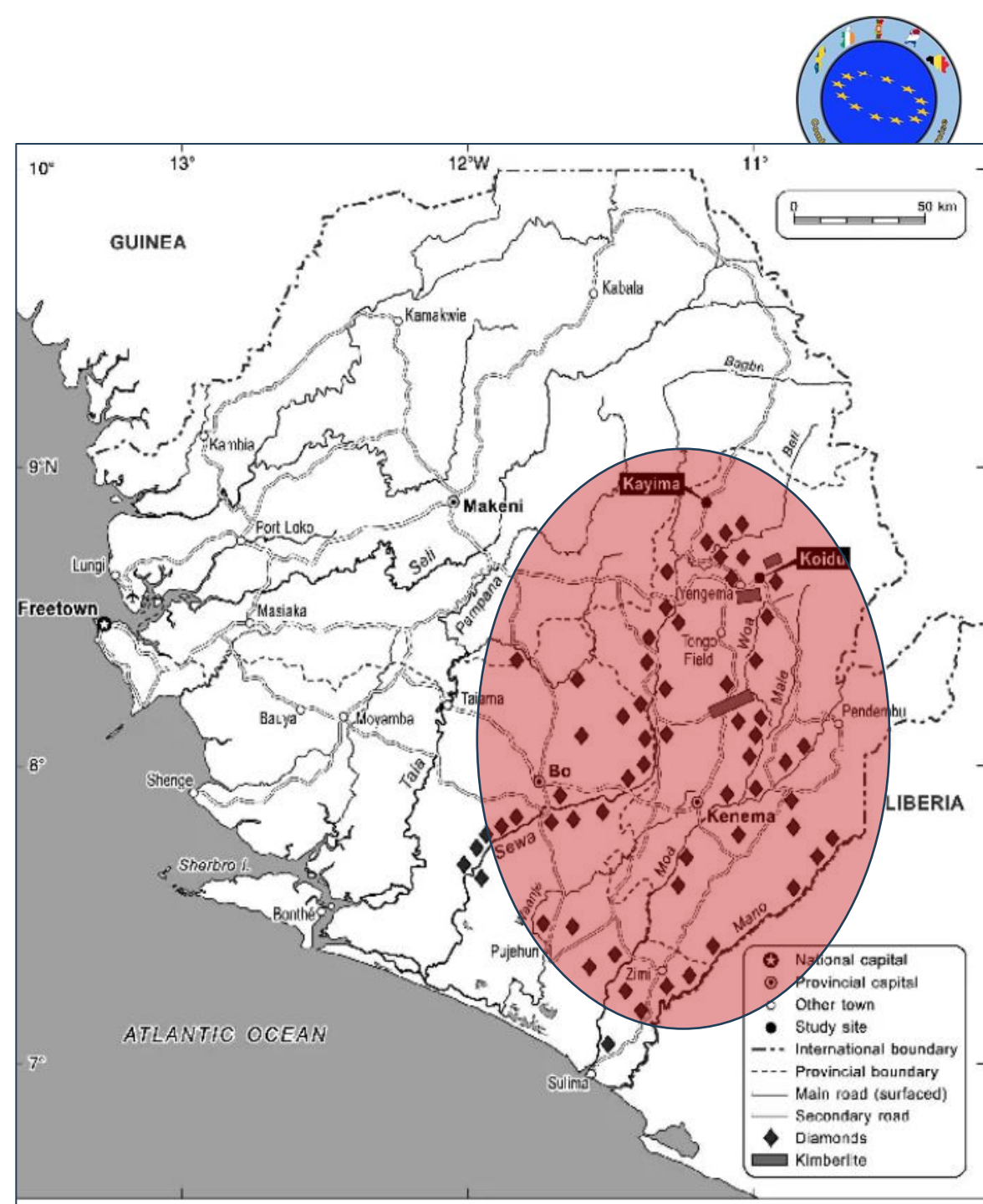
*Liberia is the key enabler for the armed factions*

*Liberian ambitions threaten regional escalation*

## Humanitarian Crisis

*Cusp of disaster. Mass displacement - HA denial*

*Urgent stabilisation requirements, ICCW military support required*





# Key Factors & Conclusions 1/3



| Factor                                                         | Deduction                                                                                                                           | Conclusion                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Label                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Control of diamond resources (Eastern Province & border areas) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>AFRC/RUF control of diamond areas is the main source of funding</li></ul>                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must take control of diamond mining areas</li><li>WAFOR must handover control to SL Government</li><li>Disrupt diamond flow to collapse AFRC/RUF capability</li></ul>                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/OR</li><li>OA</li><li>CNMA</li></ul>    |
|                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Diamonds enable arms procurement via Liberia</li></ul>                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must enable effective SL border control</li><li>Monitor border</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OE/CNMA/DC</li><li>CC/DC</li></ul>         |
|                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Maintaining and exploiting these areas constitutes a significant source of leverage</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Mining areas and LOCs will be defended</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>DC</li></ul>                               |
| External influence – Liberia                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Liberia provides sanctuary, arms, training and ISR support to AFRC/RUF</li></ul>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must deter Liberia from direct military intervention</li><li>WAFOR must disrupt the link between RUF and Liberia by effective border control and KLE</li><li>WAFOR must disrupt smuggling activities through ISR, border control, sanctions and KLE</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OE</li><li>OE/OA</li><li>OA/CNMA</li></ul> |
|                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Liberia seeks regional hegemony and may intervene militarily</li></ul>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must perform rapid deployment with initial entry by AIR</li><li>WAFOR must assume a robust posture to ensure credible deterrence</li></ul>                                                                                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/OE/DC</li><li>OA/OE</li></ul>           |





## Key Factors & Conclusions 2/3



| Factor                                                   | Deduction                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Conclusion                                                                                                                        | Label                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Logistic constraints (APOD/SPOD / LOCs / infrastructure) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Limited infrastructure and handling units in terms of APOD</li><li>Limited infrastructure and handling units in terms of SPOD</li><li>LOCs restrict freedom of movement and sustainment</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Securitization of Lungi critical</li></ul>                                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CR/DC/A</li></ul> |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Use of adequate AIR assets with EW capability</li></ul>                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CR</li></ul>      |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Use of Conakry for initial entry and sustainment along with Freetown</li></ul>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CR</li></ul>      |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Improve Bonthe and Freetown harbor capability</li></ul>                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CNMA</li></ul>    |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Improve LOC between Freetown and Bonthe</li></ul>                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CNMA</li></ul>    |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must secure LOCs and Initial Entry Points</li></ul>                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li></ul>      |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must harness ECOMOG and RSLMF capability in Lungi and Freetown</li></ul>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>RFI</li></ul>     |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR must possess the capability to deconflict movements with IDP</li></ul>                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CR/A</li></ul>    |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR needs to embed adequate role 1-3 med(evac) capabilities</li></ul>                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CC</li></ul>      |
|                                                          | AFRC/RUF attacks on MSRs disrupt HA and military mobility                                                                                                                                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>MSR must be monitored</li></ul>                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/CC</li></ul>   |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Monitor IDPR movement</li></ul>                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/CC</li></ul>   |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>C-IED capability needed</li></ul>                                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/CC</li></ul>   |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Freedom of Movement must be achieved</li></ul>                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>DC</li></ul>      |
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR will need to enable securitization of IDP camps and Aid distribution points</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li></ul>      |



## Key Factors & Conclusions 3/3



The Republic of Sierra Leone Armed Forces (RSLMF) capabilities limited

| Factor                                                                 | Deduction                                                                                          | Conclusion                                                                                                                         | Label                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Republic of Sierra Leone Armed Forces (RSLMF) capabilities limited | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No anti-submarine capability</li></ul>                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Pre-deployment of ASW capability</li></ul>                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li></ul>                      |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No effective control beyond freetown</li></ul>               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Conduct OMLT</li><li>Initially heavy Force protection footprint</li></ul>                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li><li>OA/CC</li></ul>        |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No naval capability to monitor EEZ</li></ul>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Initial naval presence and capability development</li></ul>                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/DC</li></ul>                   |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No SOF capability</li></ul>                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Deploy SOF</li></ul>                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li></ul>                      |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No capability to counter AFRC/RUF</li></ul>                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>WAFOR BPT neutralize AFRC/RUF</li></ul>                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/OE/DC</li></ul>                |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CDF most effective ground MIL troops (alternative)</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Useful building block for conducting SSR</li></ul>                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li></ul>                      |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No effective Cyber Ops</li></ul>                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Conduct cyber ops and capability development</li></ul>                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li></ul>                      |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No info Ops</li></ul>                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Conduct cyber ops and capability development</li><li>Execute STRATCOM</li></ul>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA</li><li>SC</li></ul>           |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No EW capability</li></ul>                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Air assets should be EW equipped</li></ul>                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>L</li></ul>                       |
|                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No COIN and – terror capability</li></ul>                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Conduct COIN ops and capability development</li><li>Conduct capability development</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>OA/CNMA</li><li>OA/CNMA</li></ul> |



# Operational Limitations & Assumptions

Constraints

- Operations will respect the internationally recognized sovereignty of all countries in the region;
- The duration of the operation is currently not to extend beyond 24 months;
- NATO will use forces from NATO Force Catalogue with Tier 1,2 and 3 forces, in order to prevent further escalation and contain the crisis;
- Close cooperation is required with HN, NGO/IO's.
- Defensive cyber operations must be coordinated with HN.

Restraints

- Do NOT conduct Operations outside JOA
- Do NOT conduct kinetic operations from Guinea
- Do NOT extend mission beyond 24 Months
- Do NOT create unnecessary escalation
- Do NOT conduct offensive cyber operations

Operational Assumptions

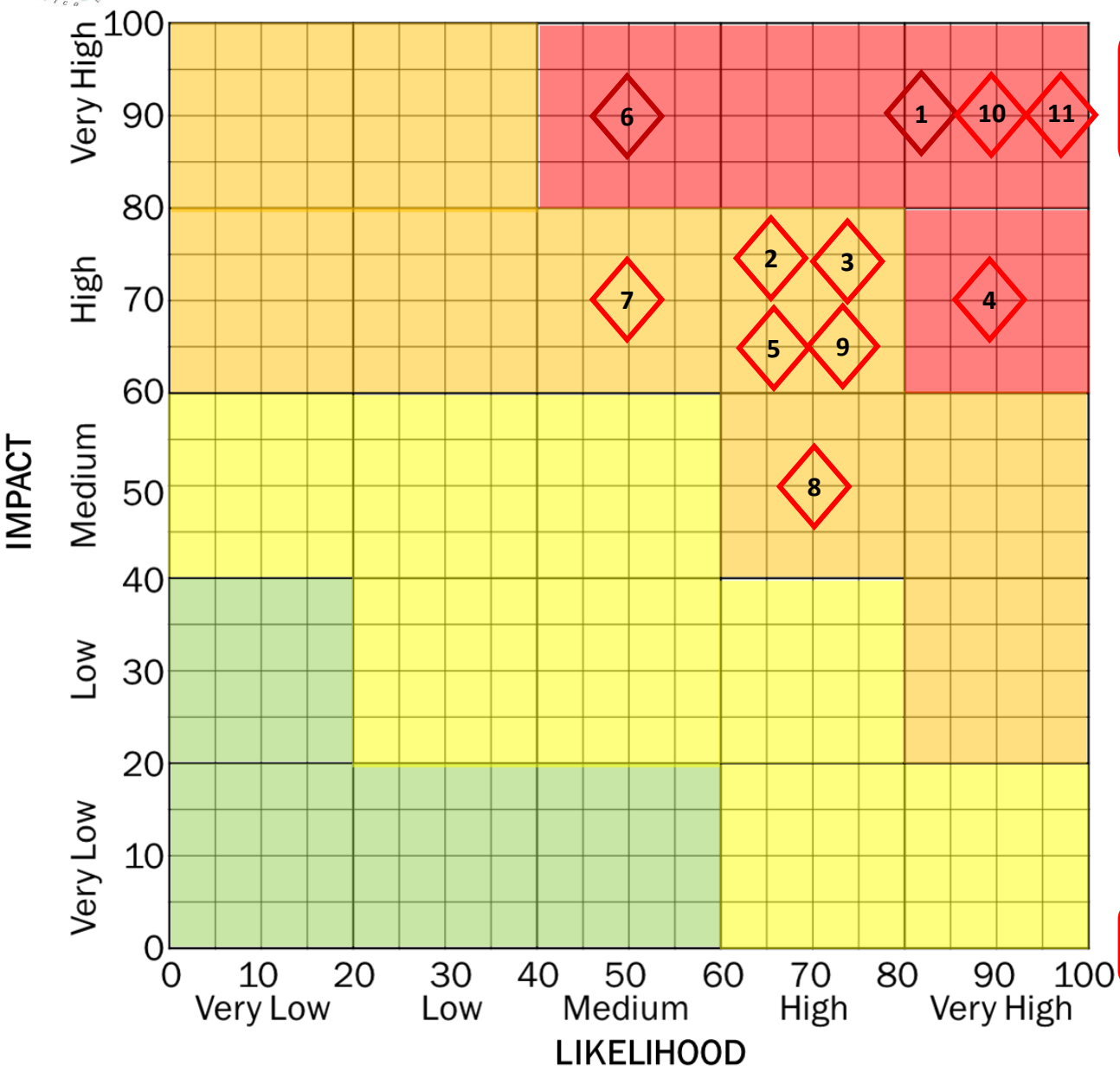
- Key enabling forces, will be generated in time to meet the required force flow;
- The limited and poor APOD/SPOD and road network will constrain operational tempo;
- Guinea will provide HNS;
- SL will provide limited HNS in Freetown;
- Legal agreements, SOFA, MOU will be in place;
- AAR Ops but not deployed in theater;
- ECOMOG able to provide local security for local population in Freetown area;
- WAFOR commander's posses a robust set of ROE's.

Conclusions

1. Indicators and warning of LIB involvement;
2. WAFOR posture must balance de-escalation and deterrence;
3. LNOs established with HN, Guinea, UN, and IO/NGOs;
4. Initial deployment must prioritize enabling forces, APOD/SPOD, RSOI and MSR security.
5. Rapid entry and transition to OMLT necessary given 24 Months end of mission. (*Mentor & Liaison Teams/Force*)



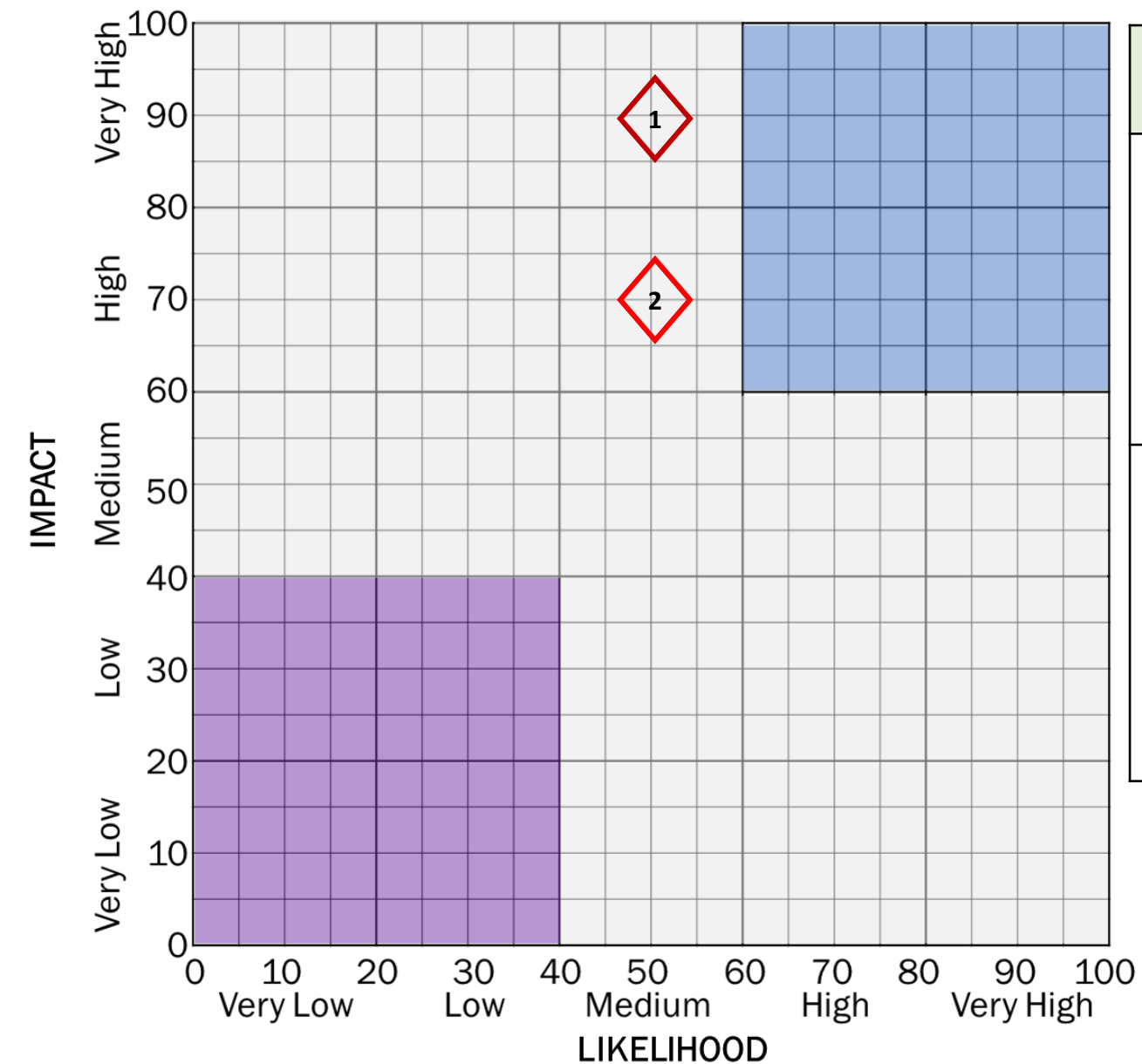
# Operational Risks



| Risk                                                                                                                  | Conclusions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 – Failure to establish and maintain freedom of movement across the JOA                                              | 1. Force package will be FP, Air mobility, Combat Engineering,, and ISR heavy.<br>2. Phase manoeuvre operations according to infrastructure capacity.                                                                                                 |
| 2 – Operational sustainment disrupted by limited SPOD/APOD capacity and vulnerable LOCs                               | 1. Secure and expand SPOD/APOD functionality early.<br>2. Establish redundant sustainment routes through Guinea.<br>3. Create forward logistic nodes and protected convoy systems.<br>4. Synchronise deployment flow with infrastructure limitations. |
| 3 - Failure to isolate AFRC/RUF operationally                                                                         | 1. Conduct border surveillance and coastal interdiction operations.<br>2. Establish RMP ans RAP.<br>3. Coordinate with Guinea and regional actors for border security.                                                                                |
| 4 - Persistent asymmetric attacks risk degrading force protection, constraining OP FOA & undermining mission momentum | 1. Maintain robust FP-posture.<br>2. Integrate SOF/INTEL capabilities                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 5 - Sustained humanitarian access within JOA denied                                                                   | 1. Help secure humanitarian corridors, IDP camps and MSRs.<br>2. Coordinate operations with UN agencies, IO/NGOs and HN.<br>3. Prioritise protection cities.                                                                                          |
| 6 – Failure to contain regional escalation                                                                            | 1. Maintain operational reserve for escalation contingencies.<br>2. Perform KLE and Stratcom with LIB and Guinea.<br>3. Establish indicators and early warning<br>4. Develop branch plans.                                                            |
| 7 - HN security capacity building insufficient                                                                        | 1. Integrate SSR support into operational planning from the outset.<br>2. Develop and pursue transition criteria                                                                                                                                      |
| 8 - WAFOR messaging insufficient                                                                                      | 1. Resourcing of PsyOps, Info Ops and StratCom within all operational activities.<br>2. Conduct KLE and Stratcom.                                                                                                                                     |
| 9 – Risk to aircraft in JOA incl. Lungi                                                                               | DIRCCM equipped FW and RW assets needed                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 10 – No suitable APOD available to sustain AirOps                                                                     | Carrier-based Ops indispensable<br>Strategic Air assets need to be based outside JOA                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 11- Submarines                                                                                                        | Dedicated ASW detection and engagament assests needed.<br>Sustained integration of ASW Ops ASAP.                                                                                                                                                      |



# Operational Opportunities



| Opportunity                                                                                      | Conclusions                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1 – Air and Maritime superiority enables operational effects</b><br><b>VERY HIGH - MEDIUM</b> | Request carrier from SHAPE to TIER1                                                                   |
| <b>2 – Air mobility enhances operational effects</b><br><b>HIGH - MEDIUM</b>                     | Prioritize usage Airmob capabilities Air and Land.<br>Request Airmob capabilities from SHAPE to TIER1 |





## Mission Statement (*DRAFT*)



**“NATO WAFOR conducts joint operations from D-DAY within the Sierra Leone Theatre of Operations in order to, restore SL territorial sovereignty, neutralize AFRC/RUF insurgent capability, enable humanitarian operations, and create conditions for transition to effective host nation security control**

### Operational Objectives

Maintain NATO-WAFOR coalition legitimacy

Territorial Integrity of Sierra Leone established

FoM established within Sierra Leone ToO

Sierra Leone Armed Forces FOC



# Operational Objectives & Centres of Gravity Analysis

## Operational Objective 1

### Territorial Integrity of Sierra Leone established

Restore GoSL authority over Freetown, key terrain and provincial capitals; deny AFRC/RUF freedom of action across the JOA

## Operational Objective 2

### FoM established

Establish and maintain Freedom of Movement (FoM) for WAFOR, UNMSL, IO/NGOs and humanitarian operations throughout Sierra Leone

## Operational Objective 3

### Sierra Leone Armed Forces Able to Maintain Security

Develop sustainable RSLMF/ECOMOG capability able to independently maintain security, protect the population and support Government authority throughout Sierra Leone.

## Centre of Gravity Analysis

### Adversary CoG — AFRC/RUF

#### Critical Capability

Diamond-funded arms procurement via Liberia

#### Critical Requirement

Access to Eastern Province mining areas and Liberian support network

(Control the mines – control the conflict)

#### Critical Vulnerability

Dependence on porous border and single funding stream

### Friendly CoG — WAFOR Ground Force

#### Critical Capability

Joint force projection and sustainment superiority, train & mentor RSLMF

#### Critical Requirement

Secure APOD/SPOD, LOCs and Guinea HNS

#### Critical Vulnerability

Limited infrastructure and RSLMF reliance



# Commander's Intent (DRAFT)



## Purpose

Rapidly **ENABLE** a permissive environment in Sierra Leone by **ISOLATING** and **NEUTRALISING** AFRC/RUF, **SECURING** key terrain and Lines of Communication, and **ENABLING** humanitarian operations throughout the Joint Operations Area.

## Method

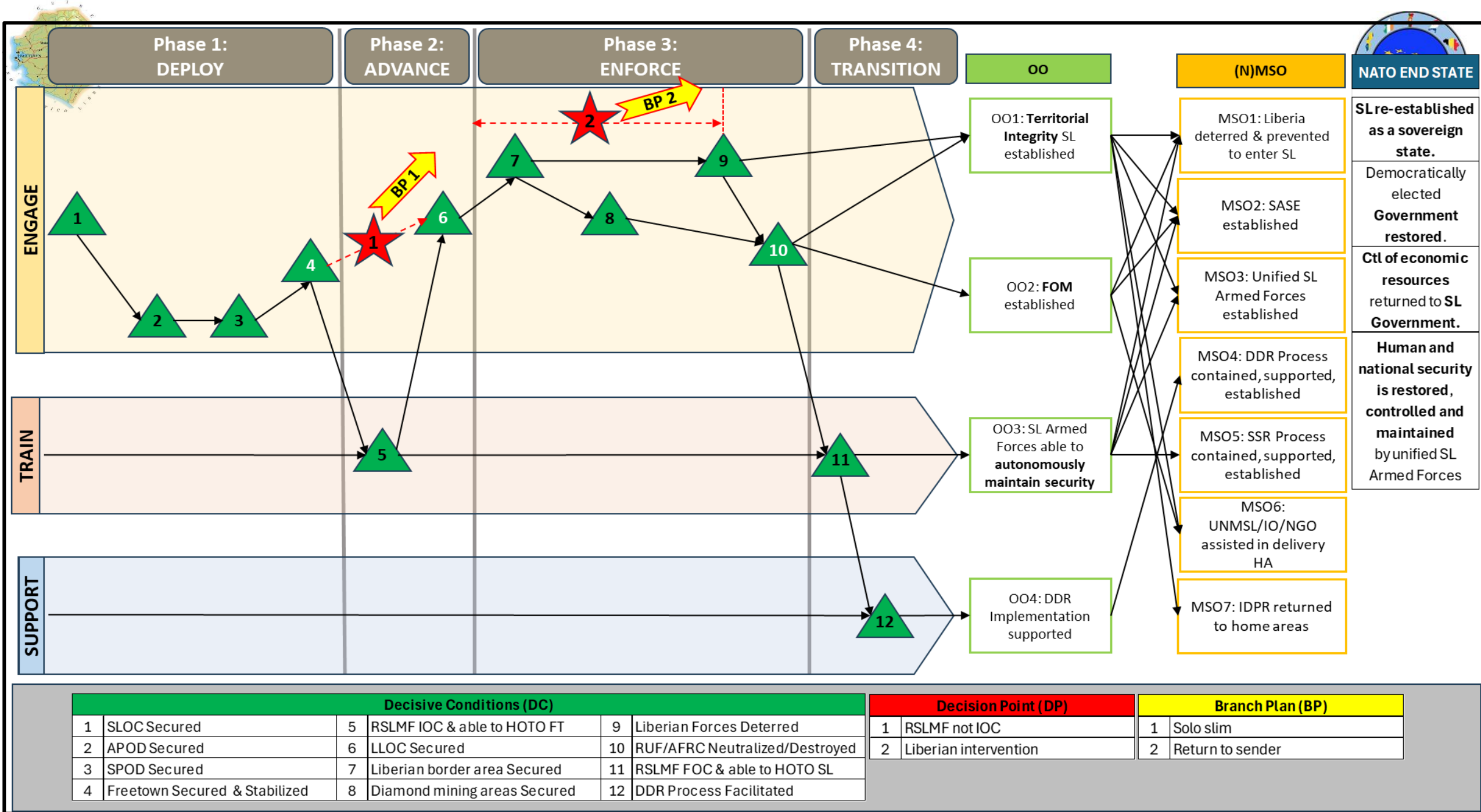
I will achieve this with a **ME that will focus on restoring territorial integrity**, starting in the capital and extending progressively to border regions and diamond-producing areas, in order to reestablish governmental authority — while **deterring Liberian interference** and **preventing regional escalation**. Simultaneously, WAFOR will contribute to the development of effective RSLMF security capabilities, **enabling SSR and DDR implementation**, ensure the **protection of civilians** and **HA enablement** setting conditions for long-term stability after transition of defense and security responsibilities.

## End State

The **Government of Sierra Leone exercises effective control throughout the country**. Freedom of Movement is ensured. Humanitarian operations are sustained. **AFRC/RUF operational capability is neutralised**. Local security forces are capable of independently maintaining security without WAFOR support.



# **J5 Cell FRAMEWORK Development**







# Complementary Non-Military Actions



| Influencing Criteria (DC etc) |                                    | Complementary Non-Military Actions                                                                                                | Conclusions (Actions needed – Requests)                                                                  |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8                             | Diamond Revenue Interdicted        | Sanctions regime against RUF diamond brokers; international monitoring of Liberian diamond exports; ECOWAS financial restrictions | Request UN sanctions mandate; coordinate with ECOWAS economic enforcement mechanism                      |
| END STATE                     | GoSL Legitimacy Restored           | Electoral support; civil administration capacity building; international recognition campaign; diplomatic engagement              | Coordinate with UN Political Mission (UNMSL); prioritise KLE with GoSL leadership                        |
| OO2                           | Humanitarian Access Sustained      | UN/NGO coordination; humanitarian corridor agreements; IDP return programme; food and medical supply chain establishment          | CIMIC integration essential; WAFOR to provide security for WHO/WFP/UNHCR operations                      |
| MSO1                          | Liberia Deterred from Intervention | Diplomatic engagement via ECOWAS; bilateral KLE with Monrovia; economic incentives; international pressure mechanisms             | Establish indicators and warning; maintain operational reserve; StratCom directed at Liberian leadership |
| DC11                          | RSLMF Capability Developed         | SSR programme; international training support; equipment provision; defence institution building                                  | OMLT deployment from Phase 1; transition criteria defined early                                          |



# Joint Force Package Capability Estimate

Force package based on a **5-45-day NTM** generation window. Forces drawn from NATO Force Catalogue Tier 1, 2 and 3.



## LAND CC/ LAND Force

1x Lt Bde HQ + 2x Lt Inf BG  
2x Airmob Bn  
1x Mech Bde HQ + 1x Mech  
Inf BG + 2x Lt Inf Bn  
1x Arty Bn (MLRS/UAV)  
1x Engr Bn · 1x CSS Bn  
CIMIC TF · PSYOPS TF · CBRN  
TF  
Role 1/2E MTF

## ACC - AIR

1x Tac RECCE Sqn  
1x Tac Airlift Sqn  
1x AGS Det · 1x UAV Plt/Det  
1x CSAR Det  
2x Air Base Support packages

## MCC - NAVY

IFFG/FFG maritime package  
Maritime interdiction  
capability  
Sea-based sustainment  
capability  
Littoral surveillance and  
escort capability  
ASW detection assets (pre-  
deploy)



## SOF

SOCC HQ  
2x Land SOTG  
1x Air SOTG  
1x Maritime SOTG

## JLSG

JLSG HQ  
Logistics Base Unit  
1x RSOI Unit · 1x Log Sp Gp  
1x Med Sp Gp / Role 3 MTF



Successful Force  
Projection & TTT

## Force Design Initial Conclusions

**ISR is a Decisive Enabler** – Persistent Surveillance MSRs/Critical Border Areas & Diamond P.Locs

**Sustainment Architecture is Critical-Early** SPOD/APOD Control. Sus Failure = Op Paralysis.

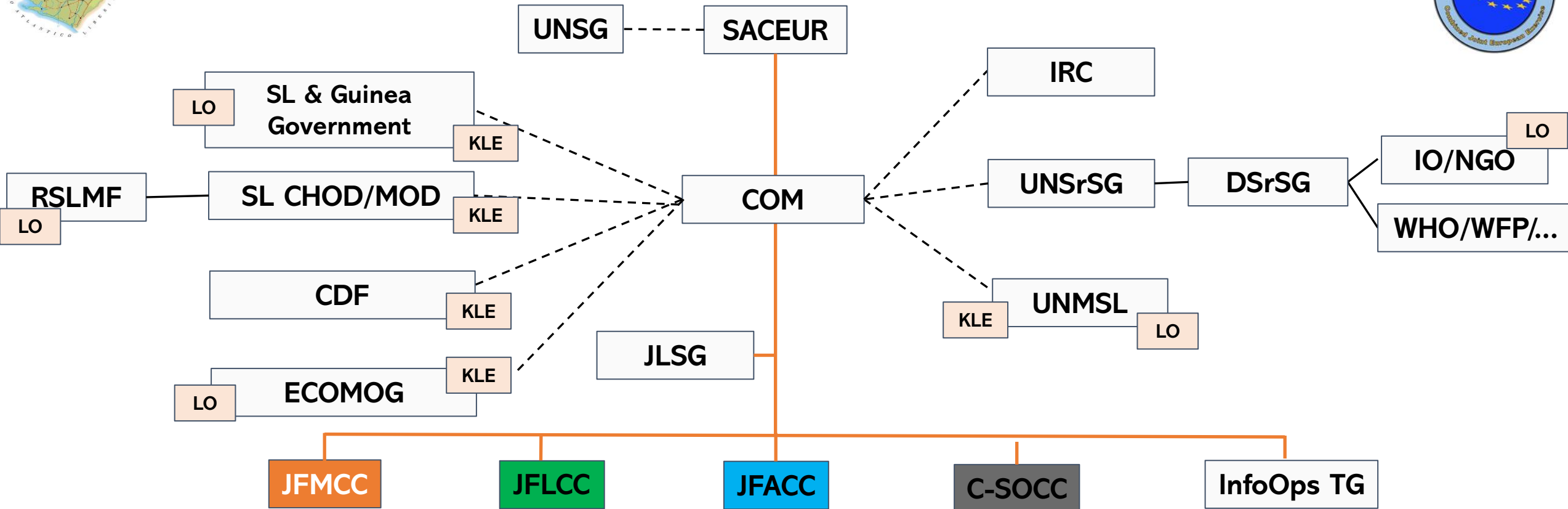
**Mobility Determines Tempo** – Enhanced RW Mob is key – allowing WAFOR to mass-effect faster than adversaries can react.

**Integrated Joint Ops Required**-No single component can achieve operational objectives alone.

**Additional Requirements:** Enhanced ISR/persistent surveillance, Rotary-wing air mobility uplift , FP assets for APOD/SPOD/LOCs, Engineer augmentation, Reserve force package (Liberian escalation), Robust MEDEVAC architecture



# Preliminary C2 Arrangements



## Key take aways

- Liaison Officer needed to ensure SA with RSMLF – ECOMOG – UNMSL – IO/NGO-
- KLE CDF leader, SL CHOD/MOD and Gov, ECOMOG Lead, Guinea Gov
- Importance of CIMIC & Info OPS with local population & partners



# Theatre of Operations – Joint Area of Operations

## Critical Terrain & Key Nodes : *Where will the fight be?*

### 1. Entry Points

**Lungi (APOD):** Critical — must be secured immediately on entry.

**Conakry:** Initial entry and HNS sustainment hub.

**Freetown / Bonthe (SPOD):** Harbour capacity requires expansion

### 2. Contested Areas

**Eastern Province:** Diamond mining areas — primary insurgent funding source and main combat objective.

**Kailahun / Kenema:** RUF strongholds adjacent to the Liberian border.

### 3. Critical LOCs

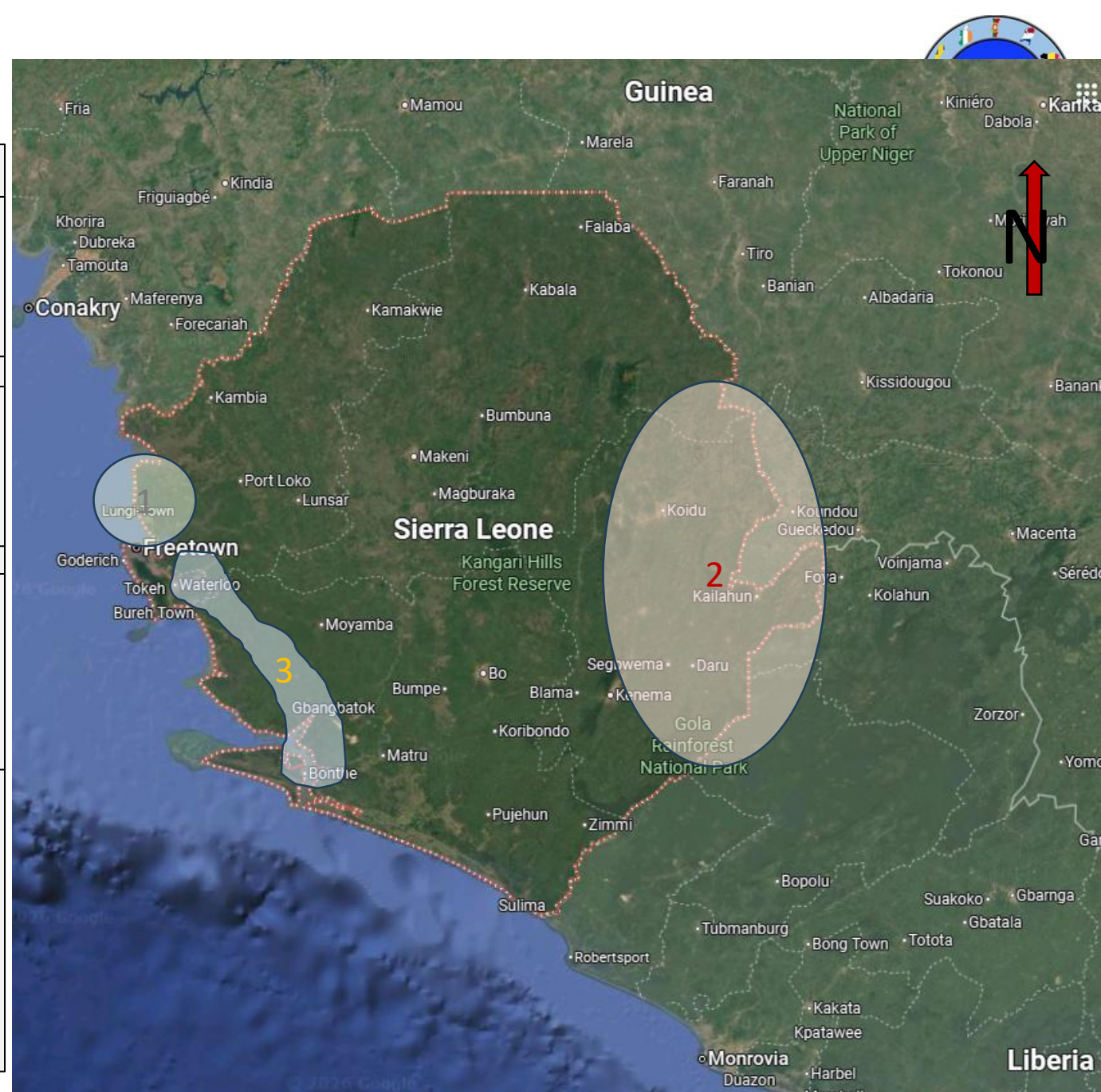
**Freetown–Bonthe axis:** Primary ground LOC requiring improvement and protection.

**MSRs:** Subject to AFRC/RUF interdiction; C-IED and route clearance essential throughout.

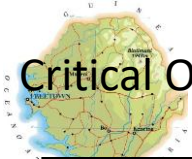
### ToO Conclusions

*The initial force design should prioritise mobility, sustainment, force protection, and command-and-control integration to establish early operational credibility across the JOA.*

**SCALABLE & RESILIENT**







# Critical Operations Requirements



| Critical Support and Resources Requirements                                                                                                        | Note                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Secure and operate APOD/SPOD (Lungi, Freetown, Conakry) to enable force projection and sustainment</li></ul> | Infrastructure constraints and adversary disruption make sustainment and mobility decisive enablers. Early control of APOD/SPOD and LOCs is critical to avoid operational paralysis. |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Establish robust and redundant logistics architecture (air/maritime LOCs)</li></ul>                          |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Deploy ISR, SOF and air mobility early to enable operational reach and awareness</li></ul>                   |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Provide force protection for LOCs, IDPs, HA corridors and key infrastructure</li></ul>                       |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Request to SACEUR for additional APOD handling unit; WAFOR could sustain two APODs for materiel</li></ul>    |                                                                                                                                                                                      |

| Pre-conditions for Success                                                                                  | Note                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Rapid and credible force generation and deployment</li></ul>          | Mission success depends on a comprehensive approach. Lack of coordination risks duplication, friction and loss of legitimacy. |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>ROE approval enabling timely and proportionate use of force</li></ul> |                                                                                                                               |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Early establishment of RSOI capacity and entry points</li></ul>       |                                                                                                                               |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Effective coordination with GoSL, UN, IO/NGOs and ECOMOG</li></ul>    |                                                                                                                               |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>GUINEA Technical Agreement maintained.</li></ul>                      |                                                                                                                               |





| Requirements for interaction with other Actors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Note                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Establish permanent liaison structures with GoSL, Guinea, UN, ECOMOG and IO/NGOs</li><li>Synchronise military and humanitarian activities</li><li>Enable cooperation with RSLMF/ECOMOG/CDF for stabilisation and transition</li><li>Coordinate regional engagement to counter Liberian influence</li></ul> |                                                                                                                                                          |
| Rules of Engagement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Note                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p>Ensure robust ROE to:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Protect civilians and humanitarian actors</li><li>Counter AFRC/RUF effectively</li><li>Deter and respond to Liberian escalation</li><li>Maintain balance between force application and legitimacy</li></ul>                                                                   | ROE must enable decisive action while avoiding escalation. Overly restrictive ROE risks mission failure; overly aggressive ROE risks loss of legitimacy. |



| StratCom / Information Strategy Requirements                                                   | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Establish integrated StratCom / Info Ops / PsyOps framework                                    | Information superiority and perceived legitimacy are operationally decisive in the SL JOA. WAFOR narrative coherence, population engagement and rapid counter-disinformation activities must support all Op phases. |
| Counter AFRC/RUF and Liberian propaganda through coordinated counter-disinformation activities |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Synchronise operational actions, strategic messaging and civilian protection narratives        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Engage tribal leaders, local authorities, media and local populations continuously             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Coordinate messaging and information activities with GoSL, UN, IO/NGOs and ECOMOG              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

| Other Critical Operational Requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Note                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Early &amp; Sustained - Civil-Military Coordination (CIMIC)</b> : Effective coordination between WAFOR, host nation authorities, UN agencies, NGOs, and humanitarian actors. Military will likely have an ENABLING role within this requirement. | Early Influencing CIMIC Ops in FREETOWN essential to generating early & sustained support for NATO WAFOR            |
| <b>Enhanced Situational Awareness Capability</b> : Consistent integration of ISR, HUMINT, and civil information to support operational decision-making and threat disruption.                                                                       | Given the insurgent aspect of the AO, access to accurate & timely info will be critical to Military decision making |



# FOR APPROVAL & GUIDANCE



## **Request (SACEUR)**

- Estimated additional force requirements: airport handling unit, ISR, air mobility, engineer TF, carrier from the start

## **Approve**

- The operational framework
- Proposed C2 structure

## **Provide**

- Commander's Initial Intent
- Commander's D&G for COA development